

UKRI AI Centre for Doctoral Training in AI for Sustainability (SustAI)

Student & Supervisor Agreement

Version 3. Last updated: 12/01/2026

Supervisor Eligibility

The supervisory team should meet the University of Southampton regulations regarding eligibility. Specifically:

- New supervisors must be members of a team that includes at least one member that has had experience of supervising research students to completion.
- Supervisor cannot supervise more than 10 PhD students in total AND cannot have a loading exceeding 6.0 FTE. Exemptions require written approval from the faculty.

Check the regulations for the full requirements.

Equality, Diversity and Inclusion

All supervisors must successfully complete these on-line courses (see blackboard.soton.ac.uk and select "Equality & Diversity in Practice) *before commencing supervision* and copies of electronic certificates must be provided to the CDT Manager:

- Equality & Diversity Briefing
- Managing Diversity

All students must successfully complete the mandatory training from the Doctoral College. In particular, the following training should be completed *before progressing to Year 2* and copies of electronic certificates must be provided to the CDT Manager:

- Equality & Diversity Briefing
- Research Ethics Basic Training (from Doctoral College)
- UoS Research Integrity (from Doctoral College)

See Doctoral College webpages for the full list of mandatory training:

[https://soton.ac.uk/sharepoint.com/teams/PGRDevelopmentHub/SitePages/Mandatory-Training\(1\).aspx](https://soton.ac.uk/sharepoint.com/teams/PGRDevelopmentHub/SitePages/Mandatory-Training(1).aspx)

Supervision

All members of the supervisory team must provide regular support and guidance to the student throughout the Summer Project and Years 2-4. The norm is for all members of the supervisory team to meet the student together each week, except for periods of holiday or leave. If any extended period of leave is planned, such as a sabbatical, this should be discussed with the student and other supervisors, and continued support arrangements must be put in place. Supervisors must inform the CDT Manager of these arrangements.

The supervisory team should be familiar with the UKRI statement of expectations for postgraduate training: <https://www.ukri.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/UKRI-300124-StatementExpectationsDoctoralTrainingJanuary2024.pdf>

Responsible Research and Innovation

Supervisors must ensure that students include a Sustainability & Impact Assessment section in their progression review reports (9 month and 20 month (confirmation)). This should follow the Orbit Framework, demonstrating that the student has anticipated, reflected on, engaged with and acted upon potential impacts of the research, considering the research process, its product and purpose and people affected. For further information see orbit-rrri.org and SUST6001 (Impact and Communication Strategies) on secure.ecs.soton.ac.uk/notes. The impact assessment should include a summary of how the student has participated in outreach.

Outreach and Engagement

All SustAI CDT students are expected to contribute in a substantive way to at least one outreach or public engagement activity per year during years 2-4. Supervisors must support and encourage CDT students with these activities. The norm is for CDT supervisors to actively participate in outreach with CDT students.

All costs for these activities are managed by the CDT.

Innovation Camp and CDT Activities

All SustAI CDT students are required to attend the annual Innovation Camp. This is a week-long residential event and is an important element of the enhanced training provided by the centre. It is the responsibility of supervisors to ensure that CDT students will attend.

A number of CDT-specific events will be scheduled through each year including the Demo Festival and regular seminars. Students are expected to attend seminars from across all CDT themes, and other CDT events; these are important elements of research training at which attendance is monitored. Supervisors are expected to enable students' involvement and are strongly encouraged to participate as a member of the SustAI CDT community.

All costs for these activities are managed by the CDT.

CDT students should engage with research group activities and seminars, and Research Centre, Graduate School and Doctoral College events. Supervisors will provide advice on which activities are important to engage with.

Progression

All CDT students will follow the University of Southampton monitoring and progression procedures as administered by the Graduate School. The SustAI CDT must be informed of the nominated assessors for progression reviews, and a copy of the reports must be provided to the CDT Manager on submission. The outcomes of review viva voce must also be copied to the CDT Manager.

At the time of University progression reviews, CDT students are required to include the following additional material in their progress reports:

- 9 month – must include an impact assessment section/chapter as specified above, and the student must have engaged in at least one outreach activity.
- 20 month - must include an updated impact assessment section/chapter, and the student must have engaged in at least two outreach activities and given a seminar on their research.

Funding and Resources

All CDT students will be based in the SustAI/MINDS CDT Laboratory in Building 60, Highfield Campus throughout their degree programme. They may have a desk in the research groups of their supervisors if space allows, but there is no requirement to provide a desk for research groups.

All CDT students have access to £1,200 per annum RTSG for 4 years and spend on this account is at the discretion of the student and supervisory team; all spend must be for the benefit of the student's research.

The CDT has additional funds for:

- Cleanroom access – students requiring access to these facilities will be considered on a case-by-case basis;
- Research visits – students (and supervisors if accompanying a CDT student) can apply for funds to travel to external academic collaborators with the expectation that the visit will lead to at least one joint publication

Costed applications for these additional funds can be submitted at any time, but approval must be received before any spend.

Research Outputs

Publications jointly authored with industry/government partners and collaborators from other institutions (e.g. enabled through research visits) are strongly encouraged.

Supervisors and students are jointly responsible for including the funding acknowledgement in all publications and for complying with open access rules.

- All research outputs (publications, data sets including code, etc.) having one of the following acknowledgements of funding:
 - Long version: "This work was supported by the UKRI AI Centre for Doctoral Training in AI for Sustainability [EP/Y030702/1]"
 - Short version: "This work was supported by UK Research and Innovation [EP/Y030702/1]"
- The final version of every research output produced by the authors following acceptance for publication (aka. 'author manuscript', 'final author version' or 'post print') must be uploaded to Pure (pure.soton.ac.uk) as soon as it is submitted to the publisher. It is a condition of the funding agency that we do this. When you upload a publication to Pure you must ensure that the SustAI CDT is added as one of the groups/organisations. See also <https://www.ukri.org/publications/ukri-open-access-policy/>

Posters, Presentations and Publicity

In addition to the acknowledgement of funding (see above), supervisors and students are responsible for ensuring that all posters, presentations, website, etc. include the UKRI logo, the University of Southampton logo, and include the full title of the CDT which is "**UKRI AI Centre for Doctoral Training in AI for Sustainability**". Whilst the abbreviated name, SustAI

CDT, can be used, the full title and the two logos need to appear prominently on all materials. Note that this is a UKRI requirement.

- <https://www.ukri.org/about-us/brand-guidelines/>
- <https://soton.ac.uk/sharepoint.com/teams/Brand>

Research Fish Reporting

All CDT-funded students must report outputs of the research through Research Fish; this is a condition on all UKRI funded research. Supervisors are expected to familiarise themselves with the range of academic and non-academic impacts to be reported through Research Fish, and to support the CDT team in ensuring students regularly report these outcomes.

- <https://www.researchfish.net/>

Note that students are sent a login to research fish only during the final stages of their PhD, and so it is important to record impacts and outputs throughout to ensure that nothing is missed.

Part-Funded Studentship Agreement

Supervisors of CDT students that are co-funded by the CDT and a partner organisation must comply with the terms of the Part-Funded Studentship Agreement established between the University and our partner. Similarly, students must be aware of and comply with the terms of the agreement.

Training Environment

Supervisors and students should hold the SustAI CDT Management Team to account for delivery of a research training environment that fulfils the expectations of UKRI; see <https://www.ukri.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/UKRI-300124-StatementExpectationsDoctoralTrainingJanuary2024.pdf>

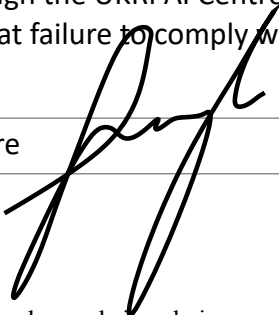
Project Title

Event-based computing for real-time computer vision systems

The project has been approved by the management team¹ ☒ Yes

Student Declaration

I understand and agree as a student funded through the UKRI AI Centre for Doctoral Training in AI for Sustainability (SustAI) and understand that failure to comply with my responsibilities will affect my progression.

Name of student James Carlyle	Signature 	Date 4/3/2026
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¹ If the project has not yet been approved or has significantly changed since being approved, please send it to sustai@soton.ac.uk for formal approval before submitting the signed agreement.

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Supervisor Declaration

We understand and agree to these responsibilities as recipients of funding from the UKRI AI Centre for Doctoral Training in AI for Sustainability (SustAI) and understand that any future engagement as supervisor is conditional on our compliance.

Name of academic supervisor	% split	Signature	Date
Firman Simanjuntak	60	<i>Firman Simanjuntak</i>	7/3/2026
Mark Zwolinski	40	Mark Zwolinski	9/3/26

Constraints on supervisory team & percentage split:

- The minimum acceptable percentage contribution to the supervision of a student is 25%
- Each student must have a minimum of two (2) academic supervisors